

ETHOS ORDER FLOW / EDUCATION



The Last Trade Before an \$18k Payout

Seven accounts, one read, then the eligibility screen

SIRES × ETHOS ORDER FLOW

THIS SESSION • 4 TRADES • 2 WINS, 2 LOSSES • NET +\$2,300 • 7 ACCOUNTS

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A full session, no cuts

what this video actually is

A New York AM open, traded live across a Tradecopia replication to six funded accounts plus a separate Alpha account, seven in total. Same price, same size, same time, on every one of them. Nothing here is a highlight reel: two of the four trades shown lost, and they are in this document for the same reason the two winners are.

The read underneath every trade is order flow only, no indicators beyond CVD and speed of tape. Location tells you where price sits in the higher timeframe auction. Absorption tells you who is defending it. Refresh and pacing tell you whether that defense is thickening or thinning. None of it is prediction. It is a read of what is actually happening at the price, and a reaction to it.

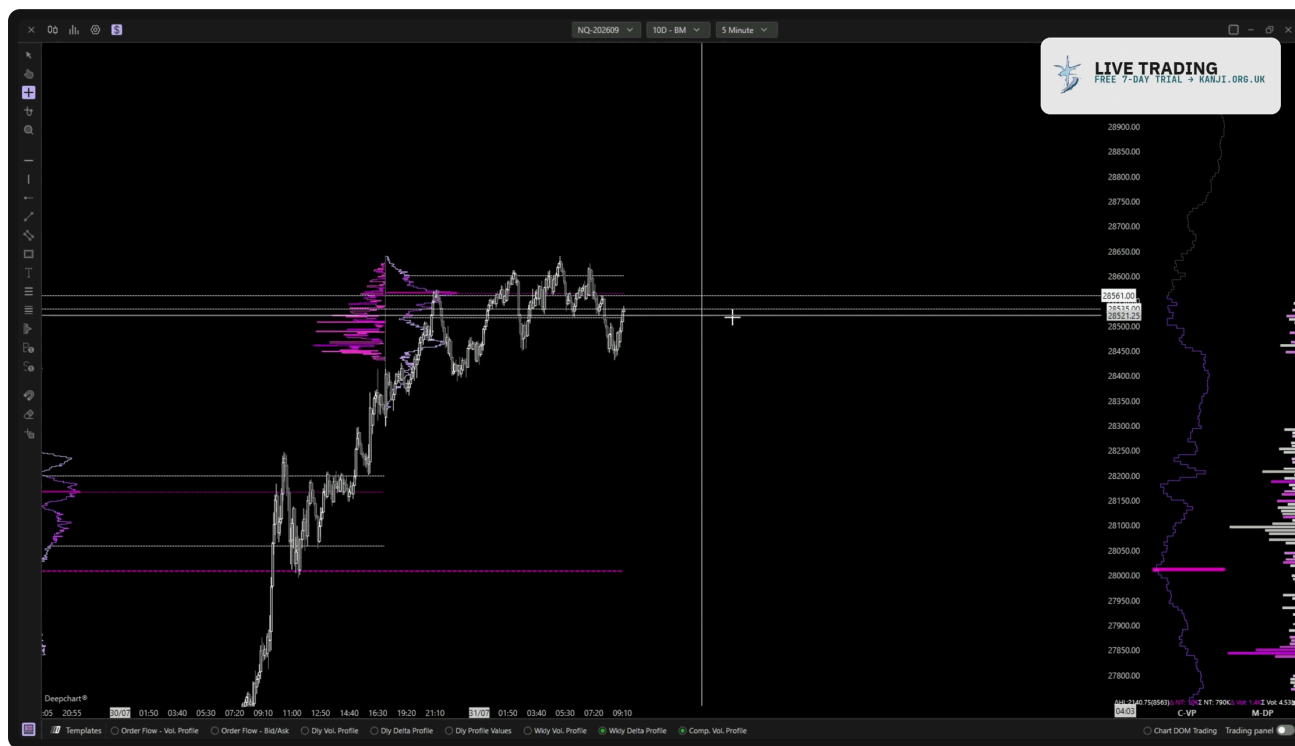
This recording opens before the trading, on the payout request for these exact seven accounts. Apex caps a single request at \$2,000 per account, so the six funded accounts clear at \$2,000 each, \$12,000 combined. The Alpha account clears separately at \$6,000. \$12,000 plus \$6,000 is the \$18,000 on the cover, requested against the same seven accounts that go on to trade this session, not a different one shown for effect.

The \$2,300 this session made is not part of that \$18,000. The payout was earned over the trading days before this one; the session below is what these accounts did on the day the payout also happened to be requested.

Four trades from this session are broken down below: two losses taken on purpose, and two wins that only happened because the losses were small enough to not matter.

The thesis before the first trade

a dealing range, a weekly delta print, and the gamma flip



The higher timeframe view drawn out before the open: the prior dealing range, three minor volume nodes marked as the levels that had already produced reactions, and the weekly delta print underneath price.

Before a single trade went out, the read was built top down. Price had broken a prior balance, come back to rebalance it, and the weekly delta footprint showed sellers trapped at the lows and exhausted on the way back up, buyers covering into that low. That is not a chart pattern. It is a record of who lost the fight for that price and who is now defending the win.

The objective was set lower, because of where the balance sat on the yearly composite to the right of price: a lot of built-up value above and comparatively little below, which is the kind of asymmetry that makes one direction the path of least resistance rather than a guess.

SHORT GAMMA, STATED AT THE OPEN

"We have this and we are currently in a short gamma, and know that short gamma environment." Chat pointed out one gamma model was reading positive. The honest answer given live: price was sitting almost exactly on the flip between the two, close enough that either read was defensible, and the trade plan did not change because of it.

Trade 1: the pre-file entry

Paying for buffer, and losing the toll



The order ticket at the open: sold 1 at a 2.00 R:R, a small white box marking the pre-file entry itself, stopped for -\$100 before the level ever confirmed.

The first trade of the day went out before there was anything to confirm it, on purpose. "No, I actually risked really less in my first two trades." The point of a pre-file entry is not to be right, it is to buy a small amount of buffer on the session cheaply, in case the real setup a few minutes later needed the room. This one did not work. Sellers never got absorbed the way the thesis wanted, and the stop paid its toll for -\$100 across the book.

Graded honestly afterward, on reviewing the session: a B plus at best, not a strong setup, entered anyway because the cost of being wrong on a pre-file entry is small and known in advance. That is the whole trade. It is in this document because most of what gets shown from a winning session quietly edits this part out.

Reading absorption in real time, before it confirms, is what the free trial's live sessions walk through.

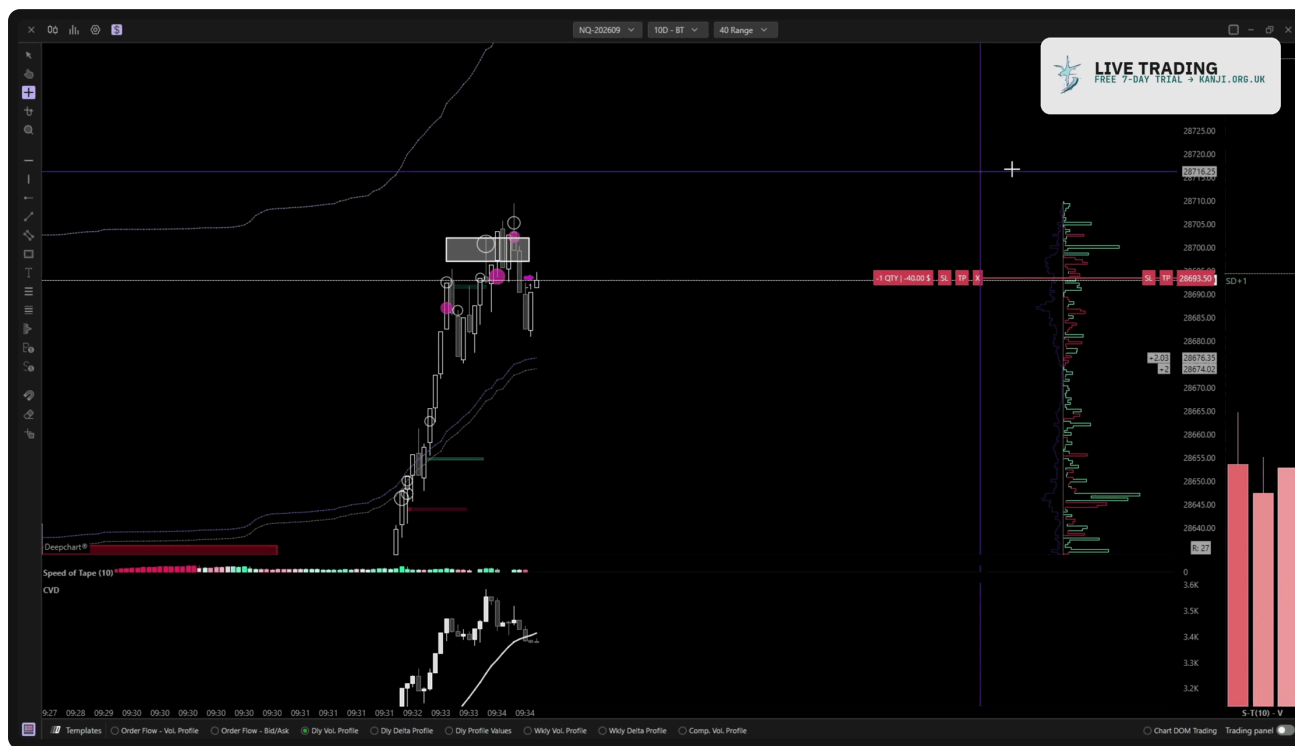
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06

Trade 2: still too early

The same mistake, once more, on purpose



A second short order live on the book, -\$40 risked, stopped moments later. Buyers absorbed the sell aggression that was supposed to confirm the level.

The second trade is the one that gets cut from most recap videos, because it repeats the first one's mistake rather than fixing it. Sellers pushed in again, looked aggressive on the tape, and got stopped out by buyers who simply would not give the level up. "I might have just got checked out." Small size again, -\$40, a scratch rather than a real loss, but a loss all the same.

Two trades in and the session is down two, both on the short side, both before the market had actually shown its hand. That is not hesitation and it is not stubbornness. It is what testing a level properly looks like when the level does not cooperate: you pay the small, known price twice, and you do not change the thesis because of it. The thesis was never about these two trades. It was about what buyers and sellers did next.

Trade 3: the origin of the move

Part one, where the real entry actually sits



Marked "OFM" on the chart itself: sellers absorbed at this exact level before, and the read is that whoever is in control here proves it by holding the retest.

"This would be the origin of the moves set up right here. If you go below this and retest it." That is the whole model in one sentence: find the price where control changed hands the first time, wait for the market to come back and test whether the same side still holds it, and only enter once that retest actually happens with real selling participation behind it, not just a touch.

The first two attempts at this exact level did not have that participation and were let go. The third attempt did: "Now we need to go below, we retest it with a decent amount of aggression, I'm in." Sellers refreshed at the level rather than thinning out, which is the tell that separates a level worth defending from one that is about to give way.

A level does not become the trade because price touched it. It becomes the trade when the same side defends it a second time, with more conviction than the first.

Trade 3: protected highs

How a stop trails a move it does not yet believe in



Mid-trail: the stop order has moved to +\$775 locked in, the resting target sits at \$2,300. Neither figure is the trade's final result, both are the position being managed live.

The starting reward against the risk on this entry was 0.69, meaning the initial target was smaller than the initial stop. Most traders skip a trade shaped like that outright, because it fails the arithmetic before it fails the read. It is worth taking anyway when the level behind it is strong, because the reward the entry started with is not the reward the trade ends with.

Once price took out the first swing low with enough aggression to close below it, that high became what gets called a **protected high** in this framework: a point the stop can move to and leave alone, because giving it back would mean the read was wrong in the first place. "Once we go below this, it becomes again a protected high, in terms of micro mechanics I can trail further." Each new low that closed with real speed of tape behind it created the next one, and the stop walked down behind price one protected high at a time rather than by a fixed distance.

This is trailing convexity: the risk on the trade shrinks every time the market proves the read correct again, so the position gets to keep running long after a fixed stop would have taken profit and moved on.

09 Trade 3: the close

R:R 0.69 becomes a session



Later in the same trail: stop now at +\$1,240, resting target raised to \$2,645. The order ticket, not the account total, which is the recap on page 13.

By the time this trade closed, the running total for the session read "up 1.6, 1.6k. I took two losses and then we have this one." A trade that started at less than one to one on paper had, by itself, turned two losing trades into a green day. That reversal is the entire argument for trailing convexity over a fixed target: the reward a setup starts with is a description of the entry, not a ceiling on the trade.

None of the mechanics on this trade were exotic. Every stop move was a reaction to a level the market had just defended a second time, read the same way trade one and trade two were read, except this time the market agreed. The difference between a losing trade and this one was never the model. It was whether the level held.

Trade 4: closing the day

One more short, and the payout tape



A fresh short, sized the same as the rest of the day, entered once buyers already in control were seen absorbed rather than defended.



The same trade later, price having pushed a further leg lower under the same protected-high trailing.

"Buyers are being absorbed. I want these buys to be absorbed. They are, okay, I'm in." One more short, same size, same read, entered while the third trade's stop was already locked well into profit and could not turn the day red on its own. That ordering matters: the fourth trade was affordable specifically because the third one was no longer at risk.

It closed out the session. "I am done for the day, that is 2.3k across six accounts plus one alpha account." Two losses, two wins, one of the wins doing almost all of the work. This is the trading this document is actually built around. The \$18k on the cover is these same seven accounts' payout, requested on the same day and earned over the trading days before it, not something this session's four trades made by themselves.

Refresh orders and consistency

Why a level that keeps refilling is not the same level twice

A resting order gets hit, and a moment later the same size is back at the same price. That reappearance is a **refresh**, and on its own it says only that somebody wants this price defended. What actually matters is what happens on the second and third refresh, because that is where the bluff usually shows itself.

A level backed by real size refreshes at a roughly steady pace and a roughly steady size: hit, replaced, hit, replaced, without the replacement visibly shrinking. That steadiness, not any single print, is what a large resting participant actually looks like on the tape, because a genuine defender does not run out of appetite three prints in. A level that is really just one order rotating through a queue thins out fast: each refresh a little smaller than the last, the pacing between them stretching out, until it stops coming back at all. That thinning is what precedes the level finally giving way, which is exactly the tell trade three's entry was built on: not that sellers showed up once, but that they kept showing up with the same conviction on the retest.

FROM THE SESSION

"Sellers common, they're refreshing pretty strongly." And later, watching a different level fail the same test: "these buyers are failing, they're refilling again, the refill concept with selling pressure coming in with aggressiveness." Same mechanism, read on both sides of the market.

This is also why a single absorption print is never enough to act on by itself. Absorption only says an aggressive order got stopped passively once. Consistency across several refreshes is what tells you whether that was a wall or a coincidence.

Delta protection and covering the book

Two different mechanisms wearing the same sentence

"Covering" gets used two different ways in this session, and they are not the same mechanism even though they sound alike.

The first is **options dealer hedging**, the mechanical side of the gamma discussion at the open. A dealer who has sold options is typically short gamma: as price moves against their position, they have to buy into strength and sell into weakness just to stay flat, not because they have a view, because their risk desk requires it. That hedging flow tends to amplify whatever the market is already doing rather than calm it down, which is the actual reason a short gamma regime produces faster, wider moves than a positive gamma one. It is regulatory-grade risk management, not a read.

The second is **ordinary short covering**, which is what the session actually points at when price is read live: "buyers are covering themselves, here are these lows." Any participant who sold and is now underwater buys back to close the position out. It shows up on the tape as passive buying at a level that has already been tested and failed to break, and it is the mechanism behind the term this framework calls a **protected high**: a level defended by real covering, not by one large resting order, which is why giving it back would mean the read itself was wrong rather than the stop being merely close.

THE DISTINCTION THAT MATTERS

Dealer hedging happens because a firm's risk model requires it, regardless of what anyone thinks the market will do next. Short covering happens because a trader lost the argument and is closing the position. Both show up as buying pressure. Only one of them tells you anything about who is actually winning the fight for the price.

The session, in full

Every account, every trade, one table

TRADE	SETUP	RESULT
1	Pre-file short at the open, buffer only	-\$100
2	Short, same level, absorbed by buyers	-\$40
3	Origin of the move, trailing convexity	the session's winner
4	Short, buyers absorbed, closed the day	closed +\$2,300 combined

SEVEN ACCOUNTS, AND THE \$18,000

Six funded accounts replicated through Tradecopia plus one Alpha account, same fills, same size, same time, on every one, net +\$2,300 for this session. The \$18,000 on the cover is the payout requested against these same seven accounts, capped at \$2,000 per Apex account by the firm's own per-request limit, six of them at \$2,000 each plus \$6,000 from Alpha. Earned over the trading days before this one, requested on the day this session happened to be recorded.

Before the next session

What this session actually checks for

BEFORE THE OPEN

- ☐ The higher timeframe dealing range is marked, with the minor volume nodes that have already produced a reaction.
- ☐ The weekly delta print is checked for who got trapped and who is covering.
- ☐ The gamma regime is named, even when it sits near the flip and the answer is genuinely close.

ON THE ENTRY

- ☐ A pre-file entry is sized small on purpose, as buffer, never as a conviction trade.
- ☐ A level is only traded once it has been tested and defended a second time, with refreshing size behind it.
- ☐ A low starting R:R is not a reason to skip the trade if the level behind it is strong.

MANAGING THE TRADE

- ☐ The stop moves to the next protected high only after price closes below the prior one with real aggression.
- ☐ Covering by the losing side is read as confirmation, not confused with dealer hedging flow.
- ☐ A later trade is only sized up once an earlier one is no longer at risk.

Two losses, two wins. Same process every time.

This is what the mentorship actually teaches: not a signal to copy, the reads themselves. Refresh and consistency, protected highs, the difference between a dealer hedging and a trader covering a loss. The free 7 day trial gets you the live sessions and the foundations to start reading it yourself.

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Takes two minutes. Cancel in two clicks if it is not for you.

If the two losses in this session put you off, that is the point. It should. This is not a strategy that wins every trade, it is a process that survives the trades it does not.

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